THE FORGING OF THE WHITEPAPERS

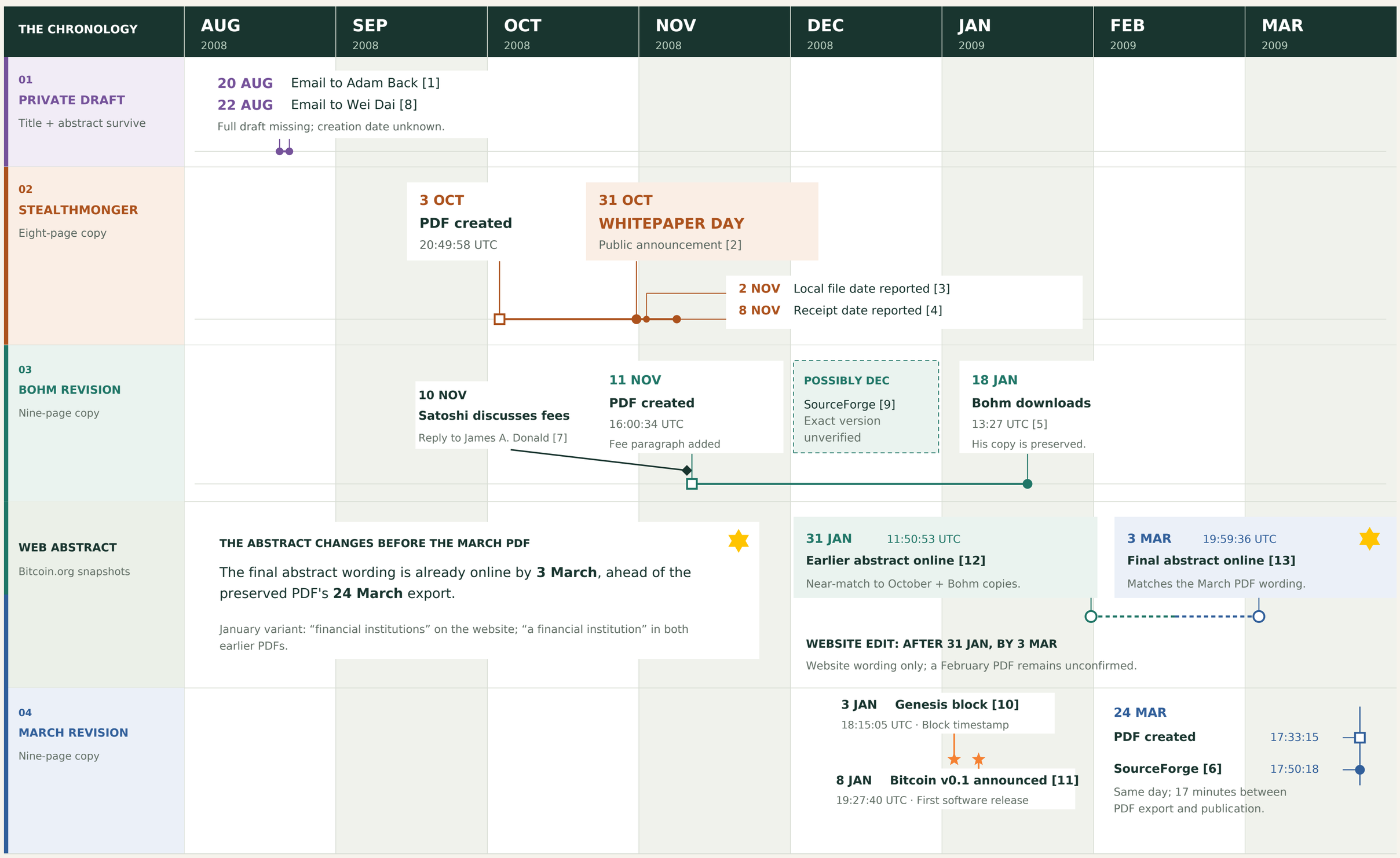
The Bitcoin Whitepapers

Four documentary stages. Three surviving PDF versions. All times shown in UTC.

AUGUST 2008 - MARCH 2009

Colour follows each version from creation to circulation.

□ PDF creation / export ● Circulation / preservation ○ Website capture ◆ Bitcoin milestone ------ Inferred timing / unverified PDF



Dashed December window: inferred from a 6 Jan 2009 archive capture; late November is not excluded. No hash identifies the hosted version.

Equal-width months; markers follow the day within each month. Website captures show abstract wording, not the linked PDF's contents.

THE RECORD 2008-2009	01 PRIVATE DRAFT August 2008	02 RELEASE-ERA COPY October 2008	03 BOHM REVISION November 2008	04 MARCH REVISION March 2009
Circulation record	**20 Aug 2008** 17:30:39 UTC Private email to Adam Back [1]	**31 Oct 2008** 18:10:00 UTC Public announcement [2]	**Possibly Dec 2008** On SourceForge [9] Version unverified; Bohm’s copy downloaded 18 Jan 2009 [5]	**24 Mar 2009** 17:50:18 UTC SourceForge RSS pubDate [6]
Web abstract record	Unknown Full August PDF unavailable	Near-match to 31 Jan webpage [12] Same PDF abstract as Bohm	**31 Jan 2009** 11:50:53 UTC [12] Earlier wording still online	**3 Mar 2009** 19:59:36 UTC [13] Final wording already online
PDF export metadata	Unknown Full August PDF unavailable	**3 Oct 2008** 20:49:58 UTC	**11 Nov 2008** 16:00:34 UTC	**24 Mar 2009** 17:33:15 UTC
What survives	**Title + abstract** Page count unknown	**Complete PDF** 8 pages	**Complete PDF** 9 pages	**Complete PDF** 9 pages
Word edits vs previous stage	**Baseline** Known fragments only	**8*** 7 title + 1 abstract	**60** 59 added + 1 deleted	**53** See counting note below
Main changes	Proposal titled **Electronic Cash Without a Trusted Third Party**.	Adopts the **Bitcoin title**; “offer” becomes “provide” in the abstract.	Adds **transaction fees** and a possible transition to fee-only incentives.	Revises **abstract, fee and SPV wording**; moves the difficulty paragraph; changes email.
Contact address	satoshi@anonymousspeech.com Email sender; PDF unknown	satoshi@vistomail.com Printed in the PDF	satoshi@vistomail.com Printed in the PDF	satoshin@gmx.com Printed in the PDF
Preserved through	Adam Back and Wei Dai Correspondence [1, 8]	StealthMonger / Gwern Preserved PDF [3, 4]	Nicholas Bohm Exhibit NB1; COPA v Wright [5]	bitcoin.org / SourceForge PDF + archived RSS evidence [6]

SHARED BY ALL THREE PDFs Writer / OpenOffice.org 2.4 • PDF 1.4 • en-GB • US Letter

* 8 compares the surviving August title and abstract only; changes to the missing full draft cannot be counted.

Counts: one added, deleted or replaced word = one edit within corresponding passages; case, punctuation and layout ignored. The unchanged 39-word difficulty paragraph moves between sections.

Circulation entries record different events. The eight-page copy is consistent with the release-era paper; its exact bytes at the announcement time are not independently captured.

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METADATA & PROVENANCE

The evidence behind the timeline

Shared settings belong in one table; chronology and file identity need distinct labels.

COMMON PDF SETTINGS

Creator / producer	Writer / OpenOffice.org 2.4
PDF format / page size	1.4 / US Letter (612 × 792 pt)
Document language	en-GB
Metadata author / title	Fields absent; name and title visible on page 1

The language tag is a document setting. It does not establish nationality or physical location. Export metadata is not a download timestamp.

EMBEDDED FONT VERSION STRINGS

Century Schoolbook Bold	2.35
Times New Roman Regular	3.00
Times New Roman Bold	3.00
Arial	3.00
Times New Roman Italic	2.76
OpenSymbol	1.10
Courier New	2.76

These version strings match across all three PDFs. All seven font programs match byte-for-byte between StealthMonger and Bohm. March reorders the regular Times New Roman subset while preserving the same glyph records and spacing.

FILE IDENTITY & PRESERVATION

STEALTHMONGER

BBD1C86BA0031ECDEFBD1FEDE45329B2

Reported dates differ: local file date 2 Nov 2008 [3]; reported receipt 8 Nov 2008 [4]. Neither provides a time or timezone. The published SHA-256 matches the Gwern copy.

NICHOLAS BOHM

693BFE527899A65C197B4CD42561A6C4

Downloaded 18 Jan 2009, 13:27 UTC [5]. A 6 Jan 2009 SourceForge capture lists bitcoin.pdf as added “1 month ago” [9], supporting possible December availability. The listing does not identify the exact PDF version.

MARCH 2009

CA1B0A44BD542453BEF918FFCD46DC04

Archived RSS pubDate: 24 Mar 2009, 17:50:18 UTC. Appendix PM3 [6] reproduces that entry with the matching MD5, corroborating this version. The RSS capture is dated 28 Nov 2009.

Relevant context: Satoshi discussed transaction fees in a reply to James A. Donald on 10 Nov 2008 at 02:14:30 UTC [7], before the Bohm PDF export. This supports context for the addition; direct causation remains an inference.

BITCOIN.ORG ABSTRACT / Two dated observations

31 Jan 2009, 11:50:53 UTC [12]: earlier abstract, with “financial institutions” where both earlier PDFs say “a financial institution.”
3 Mar 2009, 19:59:36 UTC [13]: abstract matches the March PDF after normalising whitespace. This brackets the website edit.

This narrows the **website edit**, not when Satoshi began revising the paper. A February PDF with revised wording remains unconfirmed. The preserved final PDF records a 24 March export; an earlier export would be a different file.

SOURCE KEY / Click a source name in the PDF

[1] Adam Back correspondence, Exhibit AB1

[2] Public announcement, 31 October 2008

[3] StealthMonger: local date, 2 November

[4] StealthMonger: receipt date and SHA-256

[5] Bohm witness statement, paragraph 19

[6] Madden Appendix PM3, paragraphs 33-35

[7] Satoshi replies to James A. Donald

[8] August correspondence with Wei Dai

[9] SourceForge, 6 Jan 2009 (supplied screenshot)

[10] Genesis block timestamp, Bitcoin Core

[11] Bitcoin v0.1 announcement, 8 January 2009

[12] Bitcoin.org: earlier abstract, 31 January 2009

[13] Bitcoin.org: final abstract, 3 March 2009

StealthMonger PDF ↗ Bohm PDF ↗ Canonical PDF ↗

Word counts follow the accompanying audit: 8 known-fragment edits, then 60 and 53. Counting capitalisation makes the last figure 54. “Secret” and “more permissive” describe interpretations, not metadata fields.

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